

**ANGELO
GEORGE**
CEO, BISLERI
INTERNATIONAL



“Bisleri imported a plastic recycling machine in the early 1990s. We have a good understanding of the whole model today”

earlier simply because the understanding of the market was not adequate. From a technical point of view, we had to correct a few things and the focus after that has been on the distinctiveness of taste,” she says.

76 | “We do not believe the market is saturated and if the flavours are unique, you will be in business.” Angelo chips in by saying the market for soft drinks is much larger than water, with the company’s current portfolio “having a clear synergy on both manufacturing and distribution making us a very strong competitor”.

The launch of fruit-based drinks also suffered with the imposition of the so-called sin tax levied by the government on products classified as unhealthy. “We are doing well with the range this time and the market has reacted positively,” says Chauhan. On offer are Bisleri Pop, an orange-flavoured carbonated drink, apart from Bisleri Rev with a cola flavour and Bisleri Spyci Jeera. The lemon-minty drink Limonata remains in the stable. “The non-water business brings in 7-8 per cent of revenue and the target is to take that to 15 per cent over the next two years,” says Angelo. The non-water segment includes Vedica, Bisleri Soda, and the recently launched soft drinks. It comes down now to how easily the market laps up soft drinks and the company’s ability to then ramp up capacity.

One thing it can count on is its agile marketing. It has launched a series of quirky campaigns featuring camels that was the result of a study conducted among the youth. It understood that water was moving from being just to quench thirst to a product enabling a fit and active lifestyle. So, the company has gone full steam on a hydration-focussed digital campaign featuring sportspersons like Lovlina Borgohain, Manpreet Singh,

Ashwini Ponnappa and Nishadh Kumar. Keeping with the theme, it forged partnerships with four IPL teams—Mumbai Indians, Delhi Capitals, Rajasthan Royals and Gujarat Titans—and the Procam Group for major marathons earlier this year. The IPL deal gave Bisleri a chance to sample its soft drink portfolio at stadiums. In the south, Bisleri launched limited edition partnerships with films such as *RRR*, *Jailer*, *Vikram*, *PS1* and *PS2*. That has now been replicated in the north too with a limited edition bottle in a marketing tie-up with *Jawan*, Shah Rukh Khan’s latest movie.

The pandemic threw up a somewhat unexpected opportunity of ordering water online. Now the consumer can ask for water through an app or through the marketplace. The D2C (direct-to-consumer) route gives Bisleri invaluable consumer data on areas such as frequency of

BISLERI'S MARKETING PROWESS

Some Bisleri ads over time. Based on a study conducted among the youth, it has launched a series of quirky hydration-focussed digital campaigns, featuring sportspersons and has also tied up with IPL teams

